

Great Lent and the Victory of the Resurrection

By Dn Yonnas · Fasting · Whole Parish

Summary

A lesson for the season of Abiy Tsom and Fasika: the three phases of the journey — Great Lent, Holy Week, and the Feast of the Resurrection — followed by the fifty days of celebration until Pentecost. The Church is the hospital of the soul where we find the Body and Blood of Christ, and we, the youth, are her future.

Lesson Objectives

- Know the three phases: Abiy Tsom (prepare, repent, fast, pray), Holy Week (walk with Christ to the Cross), and Fasika (celebrate His victory over death)
- Understand theosis rightly: united with God by grace, never becoming God by nature
- Receive the Church as the hospital of the soul and the Eucharist as the medicine of immortality

Key Bible Verses

1 Corinthians 15:54–57 — "O Death, where is your sting? O Hades, where is your victory?"

John 6:56 — "He who eats My flesh and drinks My blood abides in Me, and I in him"

1 John 2:6 — "He who says he abides in Him ought himself also to walk just as He walked"

Main Teaching Points

- Great Lent is a long season of fasting, prayer, repentance, and self-denial preparing us for the Resurrection
- After Fasika we celebrate for fifty days until Pentecost; the Wednesday and Friday fasts are suspended
- The Oriental Orthodox Church is the apostolic Church preserved by the Apostles and Church Fathers
- St. Athanasius: "God became man so that man could become god" — by grace, never by nature
- The Church is a hospital that heals and transforms us through her traditions and Sacraments
- In Holy Communion we partake of Christ's true Body and Blood and share in His death and Resurrection
- We are the future of the Church — the baton was first handed to us by Christ Himself

Key Terms

- **Abiy Tsom** — The Great Fast (Great Lent) — the Church's longest fast, preparing for the Feast of the Resurrection.
- **Fasika** — The Feast of the Resurrection (Easter) — the victory of Christ over death.
- **Hosanna** — Palm Sunday — the Lord's entry into Jerusalem, opening Holy Week.
- **Pentecost** — The descent of the Holy Spirit fifty days after the Resurrection — the close of the paschal celebration.

Discussion & Reflection

- Which phase of the Lenten journey is hardest for you, and why?
- What does it mean that the Church is a hospital rather than a courtroom?
- What is your role — deacon, mezemuran, student — in carrying the Church's legacy forward?

Glory be to the Father, the Son, and the Holy Spirit, one God. Amen.